

TUNKU ABDUL RAHMAN UNIVERSITY OF MANAGEMENT AND TECHNOLOGY OFFICE OF THE PRESIDENT	EFFECTIVE DATE:	2 JANUARY 2026
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Free-Rider Guideline (Students)

1. PURPOSE

This guideline provides a framework to help students recognise, prevent and address free-riding, the act of benefiting from the work or contribution of others without making a fair and proportionate contribution in return. It aims to promote fairness, accountability and academic integrity in all group assessments, group projects and research-based group activities.

2. SCOPE

This guideline applies to all students involved in group assessments, group projects or research-based group activities within the University.

3. UNDERSTANDING FREE-RIDING

Free-riding generally refers to a lack of reasonable contribution to a shared task or project.

Common indicators include:

- (a) Consistent non-participation in meetings, group discussions or decision-making;
- (b) Failure to complete assigned tasks or meet agreed deadlines;
- (c) Claiming credit for work substantially done by others;
- (d) Misrepresenting the extent of one's contribution in reports or group submissions.

Free-riding may occur intentionally or unintentionally. Hence, early communication and clear expectations are essential.

4. GOOD PRACTICES FOR PREVENTION

- (a) Discuss and document individual expected roles and responsibilities at the start of the group project/assignment/activity etc. using the Group Contract Form (Appendix A).
- (b) Encourage open communication to resolve minor misunderstandings promptly.

- (c) Keep evidence of work completed (meeting notes, drafts or communication records).

5. ADDRESSING FREE-RIDING CONCERNS

- (a) Group members shall establish their respective roles and/or tasks, and sign a Group Contract Form (Appendix A), before the commencement of a group assessment, group project or research-based group activity, and submit the Group Contract together with the final finished work.
- (b) When a group member is perceived as free-riding, the matter shall first be discussed within the team where possible.
- (c) If no resolution is reached, the concerned student(s) may submit a Student Free-Rider Report Form (Appendix B) to the Course Coordinator/Lecturer/Tutor attached with the relevant evidence(s).
- (d) The Course Coordinator/Lecturer/Assessor shall review the report and facilitate a fair resolution, which may include:
- (i) Individual performance review
 - (ii) Advisory feedback or academic counselling
- before escalating to the Programme Leader for the commencement of Investigation Procedure.

6. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Party	Key Responsibilities
Students	Participate fairly and maintain evidence of their contributions.
Course Coordinator/ Lecturer/Tutor/ Programme Leader	• Set clear expectations and guide equitable teamwork. • Address issues raised and ensure fair consideration of all parties
University Management	Promote awareness of fair teamwork and academic integrity.

7. CONFIDENTIALITY AND RECORDKEEPING

- (a) All group contracts, reports and discussions under this guideline shall be treated confidentially.
- (b) Documentation such as group contract forms or report forms shall be kept securely for internal reference only.
- (c) Confidentiality must be maintained to protect all parties involved and to encourage honest reporting.

8. CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

- (a) Faculty/Branch are encouraged to review group project/activity management practices regularly.
- (b) Feedback on the implementation of this guideline may be shared with the relevant Faculty/Branch to support continuous improvement.

- (c) This guideline shall be reviewed as needed, particularly when there are any changes to the institutional or regulatory requirements.

9. APPENDICES (FORMS)

- (a) Appendix A — Group Contract Form
- (b) Appendix B — Student Free-Rider Report Form

Appendix A

TUNKU ABDUL RAHMAN UNIVERSITY OF MANAGEMENT AND TECHNOLOGY Group Contract Form

Faculty:
Programme:
Year of Study:
Semester:
Course Title:
Course Code:
Group Assignment/ Project Title:
Name of Tutor:
Tutorial Group:

Student Name and ID	Role(s)/Task(s) Assigned	Signature and Date

TUNKU ABDUL RAHMAN UNIVERSITY OF MANAGEMENT AND TECHNOLOGY
Student Free-Rider Report Form

Faculty:
Programme:
Year of Study:
Semester:
Course Title:
Course Code:
Group Assignment/ Project Title:
Name of Tutor:
Tutorial Group:

1. Name of Student(s) Reported :

2. Description of Conduct (including time, place, and other relevant details):

3. Supporting Evidence Attached:

☐ Task logs ☐ Meeting minutes ☐ Messages/emails ☐ Drafts/files
☐ Other: _____

Declaration:

I declare that the information provided is true and made in good faith.

Signature:

Student's Name:

Student ID:

Date: